Mentor Agile Academic Catalog

"Mentor Agile does not guarantee the transferability of credits to another school, college, or university. Credits or coursework are not likely to transfer; any decision on the comparability, appropriateness and applicability of credit and whether credit should be accepted is the decision of the receiving institution. "

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1. Welcome to Mentor Agile

Mission Statement:

At Mentor Agile, our mission is to empower individuals with the skills and knowledge they need to thrive in today's fast-paced, technology-driven world. We are committed to delivering industry-relevant training that bridges the gap between academic learning and professional application. Through our programs, we aim to cultivate the next generation of leaders in the fields of product ownership and management, helping them succeed in Agile environments and beyond.

We believe in hands-on learning, real-world applications, and personalized mentorship to ensure that each student gains the expertise and confidence to excel in their careers.

Overview of Mentor Agile Programs:

Mentor Agile offers a range of specialized courses tailored to meet the demands of professionals aspiring to break into or advance in tech-driven roles. Our flagship program is the Product Owner/Product Manager Course (MAPOB), designed to provide students with an in-depth understanding of Agile principles and equip them for key product ownership positions in today's tech-driven industries.

Key Features of Our Programs:

1. Industry-Relevant Curriculum: Our programs are designed in collaboration with industry experts to ensure that students receive up-to-date and applicable knowledge that can be directly applied in real-world scenarios.
2. Experienced Instructors: All our courses are taught by seasoned professionals with years of experience in healthcare.
3. Hands-On Learning: We emphasize practical, project-based learning, where students work on real-world case studies, develop their own solutions, and practice Agile techniques in a collaborative environment.
4. Career-Focused Approach: Mentor Agile is committed to helping students not just learn but also succeed in their careers. Our programs include career coaching, resume reviews, and interview preparation to ensure students are ready for the job market.
5. Flexible Learning Options: With multiple cohorts starting throughout the year and both live and online learning components, Mentor Agile accommodates the needs of working professionals and full-time students alike.

Admissions Criteria

At Mentor Agile, we are committed to enrolling motivated individuals who seek to advance their careers in Agile Product Ownership and Management. To ensure that students are well-prepared for success in our programs, applicants must meet the following basic admissions requirements:

Basic Computer Literacy:
Applicants should demonstrate proficiency in basic computer skills, including the ability to navigate the internet, use standard software applications (such as word processing and spreadsheet tools), and manage email communications.

English Language Proficiency:
All instruction and coursework at Mentor Agile are conducted in English. Therefore, applicants must have the ability to speak, read, and write in English at a level that allows them to effectively engage with the course materials, instructors, and fellow students. Non-native English speakers may be required to provide evidence of English proficiency, such as results from standardized language tests (e.g., TOEFL, IELTS), where applicable.

Minimum Age Requirement:
Applicants must be at least 18 years of age at the time of enrollment.

Educational Background:
While no formal degree is required to enroll in Mentor Agile programs, it is recommended that applicants possess at least a high school diploma or its equivalent. Previous experience in technology, business, or project management is beneficial but not mandatory.

Commitment to Program Requirements:
Applicants must be willing to dedicate approximately 4 weeks to complete the course and actively participate in live sessions, group projects, and self-paced learning modules.

Access to Necessary Technology:
Applicants must have reliable access to a computer or laptop with a stable internet connection, as all course materials, live sessions, and communications will take place through online platforms.

2. Program Descriptions and Objectives

Program Description:

The Mentor Agile The Retail Software QA Specialist Program CIP Code 11.0899 (Computer Software and Media Applications) and CIP Code 52.1803. The Retail Software QA Specialist program prepares students to perform User Acceptance Testing (UAT) and software quality assurance within a live retail environment. Students gain hands-on experience testing proprietary point-of-sale (POS) systems, store management platforms, and AI-powered retail technologies during real customer transactions. The program integrates Agile and Scrum methodologies with practical QA techniques, enabling students to evaluate software performance, identify defects, and provide actionable feedback to development teams. Emphasis is placed on ensuring that technology solutions function effectively in real-world retail settings while enhancing the overall customer experience. Upon completion of the program, students will be able to Execute User Acceptance Testing (UAT) on POS systems and retail software in a live environment. Identify, document, and report software defects using industry-standard tracking tools, Apply Agile and Scrum principles to participate in software development and testing cycles, Evaluate software functionality and performance during real customer interactions andTest and validate AI-powered retail features such as product recommendations and customer-facing tools. Upon Completion of the Program students will receive the CSM (Certified Scrum Master) certification through Scrum Alliance which maps to SOC 15-1253 (Software QA Analysts and Testers) and the NRF RISE Up Customer Service & Sales credential from the National Retail Federation Foundation.

Program Objectives:

By the end of the course, students will:

Course Breakdown

Week 1: Scrum Foundations & QA Methodology (40 Hours)

- **Credential Preparation:** Certified ScrumMaster (CSM)

- **Week 2: Retail Domain Expertise & Customer Service (40 Hours)**
  - **Credential Preparation:** NRF RISE Up Customer Service & Sales

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- **Week 3: AI Testing & Live Production Practicum (40 Hours)**

- **Week 4: Certification & Capstone (40 Hours)**
  - Certified ScrumMaster (CSM) exam preparation and completion
  - NRF RISE Up Customer Service & Sales exam preparation and completion
  - Capstone Project:
    - Comprehensive QA evaluation report on an AI feature deployment
    - Customer impact analysis using retail domain insights
  - Career development:

    - Resume preparation
    - Interview coaching
- Job placement support

Program Length:

The course is structured over 4 weeks, with each phase building on the previous one:

Week 1 Objective: Scrum Foundations & QA Methodology

This week introduces students to Agile and Scrum principles, focusing on team structure, workflows, and the role of Quality Assurance within iterative development. Students will learn core QA methodologies, including defect tracking, test reporting, and Agile testing practices, while gaining foundational knowledge of POS systems. By the end of the week, students will be prepared to operate within a Scrum team and understand structured QA processes.

Week 2 Objective: Retail Domain Expertise & Customer Service

Students will develop a strong understanding of the retail environment and customer behavior, learning how customer interactions influence technology and testing priorities. The week emphasizes customer service strategies, communication skills, and translating real-world customer pain points into actionable QA test cases. By the end of the week, students will be able to connect business needs with technical testing requirements.

Week 3 Objective: AI Testing & Live Production Practicum

This week focuses on applying QA skills in real-world scenarios, including testing AI-powered retail systems and participating in live production environments. Students will design and execute User Acceptance Tests (UAT), document defects, and monitor system performance during active retail operations. By the end of the week, students will have hands-on experience testing live systems and producing professional QA reports.

Week 4 Objective: Certification & Capstone

Students will consolidate their knowledge through certification preparation and a comprehensive capstone project. The focus is on demonstrating mastery of Scrum, QA practices, and retail technology through a detailed evaluation of an AI feature deployment. By the end of the week, students will be prepared for certification exams and equipped with practical experience to enter the workforce.

Grading Standard and Course Completion

To successfully pass the Mentor Agile Retail Software QA Program students must meet the following grading criteria:

1. **Module Quizzes**:
   Each module in the course ends with a quiz that assesses students' understanding of the material. These quizzes are designed to ensure that students have mastered the key concepts presented in each phase of the course.
   - **Passing Score for Quizzes**: Students must achieve a score of **70% or higher** on each end-of-module quiz to pass.
   - **Quiz Retakes**: Students who score below 70% may retake the quiz once. Mentor Agile instructors will offer additional guidance to students who need further support before retaking the quiz.
2. **Project-Based Assignments**:
   In addition to quizzes, students are required to complete hands-on, project-based assignments throughout the course. These assignments allow students to apply the Agile principles and techniques they have learned to real-world scenarios.
   - **Project Grading**: Projects will be graded on a pass/fail basis, with clear criteria provided for successful completion.
   - **Collaboration**: Students are encouraged to collaborate on projects and participate in group discussions to simulate real-world Agile team dynamics.
3. **Attendance and Participation**:
   Active participation is crucial to success in the course. Students are expected to attend all live classes and engage regularly with course materials.
   - **Attendance Requirement**: Students must attend at least **80% of the live sessions** to remain in good standing. Missed sessions must be reviewed via recorded materials to ensure course continuity.
4. **Final Assessment**:
   At the conclusion of the course, students will complete a comprehensive final assessment that synthesizes all key learning objectives. This assessment will include both a written component and a practical project.
   - **Passing the Final Assessment**: A minimum score of **75%** is required to pass the final assessment. The practical project must be completed to a satisfactory standard as outlined by course instructors.
5. **Overall Course Passing Requirements**:
   To pass the course and receive a certificate of completion, students must:
   - Pass all module quizzes with at least a 70% score.
   - Successfully complete all project-based assignments.
   - Attend at least 80% of live sessions.
   - Achieve a minimum score of 75% on the final assessment

3. Institutional Calendar:

Mentor Agile offers four intakes annually for the Mcourse, providing flexibility for students. The course operates on the following schedule:

- **Spring Cohort**: April 1 – June 30
- **Summer Cohort**: July 1 – September 30
- **Fall Cohort**: October 1 – December 31
- **Winter Cohort**: January 2 – March 31

Each cohort follows the same curriculum and provides continuous engagement through live sessions, project work, and mentorship.

4. Tuition and Fees

Mentor Agile offers two comprehensive course paths, tailored to provide the education and support necessary for aspiring **Retail Software QAs**:

Retail Software QA – $3,5000

Fees and Other Charges

There are no additional fees or charges beyond the tuition costs listed above. All program materials, live classes, and support services are included in the tuition for each path.

Cancellation and Refund Policy

At Mentor Agile, we offer a flexible refund policy to accommodate the needs of our students:

1. **Full Refund**: Students who cancel their enrollment before the first live session begins are eligible for a full refund of tuition fees paid.
2. **Partial Refund**: After the program commences, students may request a partial refund:
    - **Within the first week**: 75% refund.
    - **Within the second week**: 50% refund.
    - **No refunds** will be granted after two weeks of the program.
3. **Exceptional Circumstances**: In cases of unforeseen personal or medical emergencies, students may request a refund or deferment, which will be reviewed individually.
4. **Request Process**: Refund requests must be submitted in writing via email to admissions@mentoragile.com. Refunds will be processed within 14 business days of approval. The refund applies only to core tuition fees and excludes any optional materials or services already provided.

5. Student Success Data.

6. Accreditation and Certification

Accreditation Disclaimer

Mentor Agile is not accredited by the U.S. Department of Education. As a professional school focused on industry-recognized certifications rather than traditional academic degrees, Mentor Agile operates independently of U.S. Department of Education accreditation standards. Our programs are designed to prepare students for professional certifications in Agile and Product Management, which are widely recognized in the tech and business industries.

Professional Certifications and Their Importance

Certified Scrum Master (Scrum Alliance CSM)

The Scrum Alliance Certified ScrumMaster (CSM) certification is a globally recognized credential that validates a professional's ability to operate effectively within Agile and Scrum-based environments, which have become the standard across modern software development and Quality Assurance teams. This certification goes beyond basic theory by emphasizing servant leadership, cross-functional collaboration, and the ability to facilitate key Scrum events such as sprint planning, daily stand-ups, and retrospectives. For individuals entering QA or technology roles, the CSM is particularly valuable because it demonstrates an understanding of how testing fits into rapid, iterative development cycles, where speed, adaptability, and continuous feedback are critical. Employers place significant value on this credential because it signals that a candidate can contribute immediately within Agile teams, reduce friction in development workflows, and support higher-quality product delivery. As organizations continue to prioritize Agile transformation, the CSM certification serves as a strong differentiator in the job market and provides a foundation for long-term career growth in roles such as QA Analyst, Scrum Master, Product Owner, and other Agile leadership positions.

National Retail Federation RISE Up

The National Retail Federation RISE Up Customer Service & Sales certification is an industry-backed credential designed to develop essential workplace competencies that are critical across both retail and technology-driven environments. It focuses on building strong communication skills, customer engagement strategies, problem-solving abilities, and professionalism—skills that directly impact business performance and customer satisfaction. What makes this certification especially important in the context of this program is its direct connection to real-world user behavior, which is a key driver of software quality and product success. By understanding how customers think, behave, and interact with retail systems, students are better equipped to design meaningful test cases, identify usability issues, and prioritize defects that truly impact the end user. Employers highly value this certification because it signals that a candidate not only understands technical processes, but also brings a customer-centric mindset—an increasingly critical trait in today's experience-driven economy. This combination of customer insight and technical awareness significantly enhances

employability and prepares graduates to add value in both customer-facing roles and behind-the-scenes QA and product teams.

How Mentor Agile Prepares Students for Certification Success

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Certification Exam Process and Mentor Agile's Role

The certification exam process is designed to ensure that students not only complete the training program but also demonstrate competency through nationally recognized assessments. For the Certified ScrumMaster (CSM), administered by the Scrum Alliance, students must complete the required instructional hours and actively participate in training before becoming eligible to sit for the certification exam. For the RISE Up Customer Service & Sales certification, developed by the National Retail Federation, students must complete the curriculum and successfully pass the corresponding assessment to earn the credential. While each certifying body maintains its own standards, exam structure, and passing requirements, both certifications are aligned with industry expectations and validate job-ready skills.

Mentor Agile plays a critical supportive role throughout this process by embedding certification preparation directly into the program curriculum. Students receive guided instruction, practice assessments, and targeted review sessions to ensure they are fully prepared for each exam. The institution also provides administrative support, including exam registration guidance and scheduling assistance, to streamline the process for students. While Mentor Agile prepares students thoroughly and supports them at every stage, it does not administer the certification exams directly and cannot guarantee a passing outcome. Certification is awarded solely by the respective certifying organizations upon successful completion of their exam requirements.

By the end of the program, students will be equipped with the skills, knowledge, and confidence needed to succeed in their certification exams and excel in Agile leadership roles.

7. Transfer of Credits

Transferability of Certificates

Mentor Agile's courses are focused on preparing students for professional certifications like the Certified Scrum Master. These certifications are recognized across industries but do not transfer as academic credits to traditional degree programs, as Mentor Agile operates as a professional school, not a
degree-granting institution.

Guidance on Credit Transfers

While our programs offer valuable certifications, they are designed for professional skill development rather than academic credit transfer. Students are encouraged to explore how these certifications align with their career goals and the qualifications sought by potential employers.

8. Articulation Agreements

Partnerships and Credit Transfer Arrangements with Other Institutions

At this time, Mentor Agile does not have formal articulation agreements or credit transfer arrangements with other academic institutions. As a professional school, our focus is on preparing students for industry-recognized certifications, such as the CPHT and CET . These certifications are widely recognized by employers across industries, offering students the opportunity to advance their careers.

We continually seek partnerships with organizations and institutions that align with our mission to provide top-tier professional education.

9. Additional Program Information

Other Relevant Facts Affecting Enrollment Decisions

When considering enrollment in Mentor Agile, students should take into account several key factors that may influence their decision:

- **Industry Focus**: Mentor Agile's programs are designed to prepare students for professional certifications, such as CPHT and CET, which are highly sought after by employers in healthcare fields. Our curriculum is aligned with industry standards, offering a practical, real-world approach to learning.
- **Live Interactive Classes**: All students have access to **10 live classes** held over 4 weeks, providing direct interaction with experienced instructors and industry professionals. These live sessions offer the opportunity to ask questions, participate in discussions, and engage in real-time problem-solving exercises.
- **Career Support**: In addition to coursework, students in the **Enhanced Career Support Path** receive personalized career counseling, post-graduation support, and access to networking events. This added support can significantly enhance job readiness and success in finding employment after completing the program.
- **Flexible Learning Environment**: Mentor Agile provides a combination of live classes and pre-recorded modules, allowing students to learn at their own pace while still engaging in structured, instructor-led activities. This flexibility makes it easier for working professionals to complete the program.
- **Program Commitment**: Enrollment in Mentor Agile programs requires a time commitment of approximately 4 weeks, with live sessions and coursework designed to be completed within this period. Prospective students should ensure they have the time and resources to engage fully in the program.
- **No Transfer of Academic Credits**: As a professional school, Mentor Agile does not offer transferable academic credits. Our focus is on preparing students for professional certifications, not on traditional academic pathways.

These factors should be carefully considered by students as they assess their educational and career goals in relation to Mentor Agile's offerings.

10. Student Policies and Procedures

Attendance and Participation

Active participation is crucial for success in Mentor Agile programs. Students are expected to attend all live classes and engage with the course materials regularly. Participation in live sessions is key to understanding the course concepts and collaborating with peers. Students

who anticipate missing a session should notify their instructor in advance and are responsible for reviewing any missed materials.

Code of Conduct

Mentor Agile maintains a high standard of professionalism and expects all students to adhere to a respectful code of conduct. This includes:

- Demonstrating integrity and honesty in all coursework and interactions.
- Engaging in respectful communication with instructors and fellow students.
- Maintaining a collaborative and positive learning environment.

Any form of harassment, academic dishonesty, or disruptive behavior will result in disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal from the program.

Grievance and Complaint Process

Students who encounter issues or have complaints regarding their program experience are encouraged to resolve matters informally by discussing the issue with the instructor or program coordinator. If the issue remains unresolved, students may file a formal grievance by submitting a written complaint to the Mentor Agile administration.

Formal grievances will be reviewed by the administration within 10 business days, and a response will be provided outlining the resolution. If the matter pertains to serious concerns, such as discrimination or academic integrity, students may escalate the complaint to the Illinois Board of Higher Education (IBHE).

11. Complaint Information

Students who have unresolved concerns or complaints after following the Mentor Agile grievance process may file a formal complaint with the Illinois Board of Higher Education (IBHE). The IBHE serves as the regulatory body overseeing professional schools in Illinois and can address concerns related to academic integrity, student rights, and institutional operations.

Contact Information for the Illinois Board of Higher Education (IBHE):

Address: 1 N. Old State Capitol Plaza, Suite 333 Springfield, IL 62701
Phone: (217) 782-2551
Website: www.ibhe.org

12. Contact Information

For any inquiries regarding admissions, program details, or student support, please contact Mentor Agile using the following information:

Email: info@mentoragile.com
Phone: +1 630-521-3351
Address: 2200 S Main St, Lombard, IL 60148

Our Admissions and Support Office is available to assist with any questions or concerns related to enrollment, coursework, and student services.

13. Tuition Reduction

Discounts will be based on measurable factors such as:

- **Income Brackets: Students will need to provide documented proof of income, and tuition reductions will be available for those who fall below specific income thresholds. (FPL Guidelines)**
- **Employment Status: Discounts may be provided for individuals who are unemployed or underemployed, as verified by employment history or relevant documentation.**
- **Geographic Area: Students from underserved or economically disadvantaged areas may qualify for reductions based on publicly available economic data for their region.**
- **Hardship Conditions: Discounts may be available for students facing special financial or personal hardships, such as recent medical expenses or loss of employment, with verification through appropriate documentation.**

Institutional Disclosures Reporting Table

July 1, 2023 through June 30, 2024 (past fiscal year)

Per Section 1095.200 of 23 Ill. Adm. Code 1095:

Institution Name: Mentor Agile

The following information must be included with the enrollment agreement, catalog, and posted on the institution's website.

Disclosure Reporting Category	Program Name	Product Owner/Product Manager Course				
	CIP*	11.0103				
	SOC*	13-1082.00				
A) For each program of study, report:						
1) The number of students who were admitted in the program or course of instruction* as of July 1 of this reporting period.		0				
2) The number of additional students who were admitted in the program or course of instruction during the next 12 months and classified in one of the following categories:						
	a) New starts	0				
	b) Re-enrollments	0				
	c) Transfers into the program from other programs at the school	0				
3) The total number of students admitted in the program or course of instruction during the 12-month reporting period (the number of students reported under subsection A1 plus the total number of students reported under subsection A2).		0				
4) The number of students enrolled in the program or course of instruction during the 12-month reporting period who:						
	a) Transferred out of the program or course and into another program or course at the school	0				
	b) Completed or graduated from a program or course of instruction	0				
	c) Withdrew from the school	0				
	d) Are still enrolled	0				
5) The number of students enrolled in the program or course of instruction who were:						
	a) Placed in their field of study	0				
	b) Placed in a related field	0				
	c) Placed out of the field	0				
	d) Not available for placement due to personal reasons	0				
	e) Not employed	0				
B1) The number of students who took a State licensing examination or professional certification examination, if any, during the reporting period.		0				
B2) The number of students who took and passed a State licensing examination or professional certification examination, if any, during the reporting period.		0				
C) The number of graduates who obtained employment in the field who did not use the school's placement assistance during the reporting period; such information may be compiled by reasonable efforts of the school to contact graduates by written correspondence.		0				
D) The average starting salary for all school graduates employed during the reporting period; this information may be compiled by reasonable efforts of the school to contact graduates by written correspondence.		0				

***CIP**--Please insert the program CIP Code. For more information on CIP codes: https://nces.ed.gov/ipeds/cipcode/Default.aspx?y=55

***SOC**--Please insert the program SOC Code. For more informaiton on SOC codes: http://www.bls.gov/soc/classification.htm

***A course of instruction** is a stand-alone course that provides instruction that may or may not be related to a program of study, but is either not part of the sequence or can be taken independent of the full sequence as a stand-alone option. A Course of Instruction may directly prepare students for a certificate or other completion credential or it can stand alone as an optional preparation; or in the case of students requiring catch-up work, a prerequisite for a program. A stand-alone course might lead to a credential to be used toward preparing individuals for a trade, occupation, vocation, profession; or it might improve, enhance or add to skills and abilities related to occupational/career opportunities.

} In the event that the school fails to meet the minimum standards, that school shall be placed on probation.

} If that school's passage rate in its next reporting period does not exceed 50% of the average passage rate of that class of schools as a whole, then the Board shall revoke the school's approval for that program to operate in this State. Such revocation also shall be grounds for reviewing the approval to operate as an institution.